

New Citizens' Campaign Aims to End Washington's Clock Change Without Waiting on Congress

BELLEVEUE, Wash. — A new citizens' campaign wants Washington to stop changing its clocks, and says it will take the question to voters if the Legislature won't act in 2027.

The Last Fall Back Act would put Washington on permanent standard time right away, which federal law already allows any state to do. If Congress ever approves permanent daylight time, the state switches to it automatically. The group behind the act, Last Fall Back Washington, registered as a state nonprofit this month.

Why now?

On Sunday, November 1, British Columbia and Alberta will leave their clocks alone. So will Yukon, Saskatchewan, and soon the Northwest Territories. Washington will set its clocks back an hour.

Canada is doing it. We can't.

Washington tried first

In 2019 the Legislature voted to end the clock change and move to permanent daylight saving time. The bill passed the House 90 to 6 and the Senate 46 to 2. It has never taken effect. The law only works if Congress approves permanent daylight time first, and seven years later Congress hasn't.

Four more bills have since tried the workaround the act proposes: Senate Bill 5511 in 2022, Senate Bill 5795 in 2024, Senate Bill 5001 in 2025, and House Bill 2119 this year.

Not one of them has ever reached a floor vote.

The 2024 bill had thirteen sponsors from both parties and support from the Association of Washington Business. It was scheduled for a committee vote, then pulled before the deadline.

"Alberta went from introducing a bill to signing it in three weeks. We've been waiting seven years for permission we never actually needed," said Scott Thurlow, founder of Last Fall Back Washington. "Our Legislature has had this in front of it four times and has never once voted on it. We're not asking anyone to change their mind. We're asking them to hold the vote."

Why a state can do this alone

Federal law has always let a state stop changing its clocks and stay on standard time year-round. Arizona and Hawaii have done it for decades. Permanent daylight time is the one option that needs Congress, and it is the one Washington voted for.

The research on the switch itself isn't seriously disputed. Heart attacks rise on the Monday after the spring change. Fatal crashes climb about six percent that week, mostly in the morning and on the western edge of each time zone, where Washington sits. Workplace injuries go up 5.7 percent. Deer-vehicle collisions jump about sixteen percent the week after the fall change.

If the 2027 session ends without action, organizers would file an Initiative to the Legislature and gather roughly 386,000 signatures. That measure goes to the 2028 Legislature first, and to voters that November if lawmakers decline again.

Full text, answers to the hard questions, and volunteer signup are at lastfallback.org.

ABOUT LAST FALL BACK WASHINGTON

Last Fall Back Washington is a volunteer-run Washington nonprofit corporation working to end the biannual clock change, through the Legislature if possible and a 2028 ballot initiative if not. It has no paid staff, no corporate funding, and no party affiliation, and is not a registered political committee.

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NOTES FOR REPORTERS

Available on request: a one-page brief, interviews, and a dataset pairing published 2026-27 school bell times against U.S. Naval Observatory sunrise times across six Washington districts. It cuts against the "children in the dark" argument in some districts and supports it in others.

• **Sources and full link list:** lastfallback.org/updates/western-canada-stopped-changing-clocks · Alberta: alberta.ca/albertas-new-time-system · H.R. 139 roll call #238: govtrack.us/congress/votes/119-2026/h238 · S. 29: congress.gov/bill/119th-congress/senate-bill/29 · SHB 1196: app.leg.wa.gov/billssummary?BillNumber=1196&Year=2019 · 15 U.S.C. § 260a: law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/15/260a